

EXAMINED

FiiO M6

We've said this in the past as well, FiiO is perhaps one of the leaders in the audio game when it comes to the price to performance ratio. We've reviewed the FiiO M7, X5 3rd gen and the BTR3 amp, and joining that club this month is the FiiO M6.

The M6 is much smaller than its bigger brother, the M7. At 53.3mm×92.5mm×11.5mm and weighing approx 80grams, it is 20% smaller and 30% lighter than the M7, so you can put it in your pocket and forget about it. The build quality is what you would expect from FiiO – aluminium body with glass on the front and a back panel with CNC finishing. The interface is purely touch-based, and a tiny, easy-to-miss LED on the upper right corner indicates the device status. There are four buttons on the device for operations like power, playback, volume and track control.

The 3.2-inch, 480×800 display switches the panel from M7's TFT to an LG IPS piece. The display is quite good and manages good colour reproduction. Controlling the device through the gestures and the buttons is also pretty seamless. Our only complaint here would be the clickiness of the buttons themselves. The input/output options are also fairly



simple – a standard 3.5mm port and a USB-C port that lets the M6 double up as a USB DAC. There's also a micro-SD port on the right side that lets you expand the onboard 2GB available to up to 2TB.

The M6 comes with the ESS Sabre 9018Q2C, the exact same chip as the M7, and hence it packs the same decoding abilities. The battery life on the M6 is 12 hours, as stated by the manufacturer. The M6 has an excellent streaming capability with a lot of apps onboard to pump music to speakers via Airplay or to act as a receiver through multi-way Bluetooth connections. Since the player is based on Android, you can actually side-load a number of apps that work well with it, like Spotify, Tidal and more.

For a nearly entry-level device, the M6 definitely defies expectations in the sound department. It presents a clear and clean sound, with almost no colouration detected during our experience. Even with particularly sensitive pairs of IEMs, the M6 sounds controlled and capable, without being biased towards either end of the spectrum. Unless you throw something really complex at it, the M6 handles separation pretty well. While higher end players from FiiO do offer better performance and resolution, this one might be perfect for users looking to make the jump from using their smartphone as a source to getting a dedicated DAC.

PRICE: ₹12990/-

Corsair MM1000

Logitech's Powerplay mousepad was one of those products that enhanced the convenience of using wireless mice. Until then, wireless charging wasn't available for gaming mice and it was a useful change. A year later we see Corsair's MM1000 Qi Wireless Charging mousepad taking it on. Although the previous MM800 mousepad went all out with RGB, this one only includes an LED indicator on the top left casing to denote charging. This casing also has a USB 3.0 passthrough port to connect your keyboard or the mouse's Wi-Fi dongle. So, the mousepad has two USB connectors that need to be connected to your PC.

For now, only the Corsair Dark Core RGB wireless mouse is compatible with the mousepad. You can't simply place the mouse anywhere to enable charging. There's a circular spot on the top right that needs

to be aligned with the lower end of the mouse. Since the mousepad uses the Qi wireless charging standard, any compatible device can be charged on it. So, if your smartphone supports Qi charging, you can simply place your phone in the same spot. If your phone doesn't support wireless charging, Corsair hasn't deserted you since they have included a circular wireless charging dongle or adapter with a mini-USB connector. They've also packed adapters for Lighting and USB Type-C connectors. All you need to do is connect the dongle to your smartphone according to the connector and align the dongle over the charging zone. However, do note that the charging is going to be extremely slow through the dongle.

The Corsair MM1000 Qi Wireless Charging mousepad offers incredible convenience. You won't have to reach out for a charging cable when the battery is about to die and just move the mouse over the charging zone. However, you will have to also buy the Corsair Dark Core RGB wireless mouse or any other compatible mouse.

PRICE: TBA

